

As I went down to the river to pray

Text: African American Spiritual

Music: African American Spiritual

AS I WENT DOWN TO THE RIVER TO PRAY irregular

The musical score is written on four staves in G major (one sharp) and 2/2 time. The first staff begins with a 3/2 time signature change. Chords G, D, and G are indicated above the first three measures. The lyrics are: 'As I went down to the riv-er to pray, stud-y-in' a-bout that good old way,'. The second staff continues the melody with chords D, C, and G, ending with a 'Fine' double bar line. The lyrics are: 'and who shall wear the star - ry crown, good Lord, show me the way.' The third staff starts with a '1' and has chords D, G, C, and G, with lyrics: 'Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, let's go down, come on down.' The fourth staff continues with chords D, G, C, and G, ending with a 'D.C.' (Da Capo) instruction. The lyrics are: 'Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, down to the riv-er to pray.'

As I went down to the riv-er to pray, stud-y-in' a-bout that good old way,
and who shall wear the star - ry crown, good Lord, show me the way.
1 Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, let's go down, come on down.
Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, down to the riv-er to pray.

2. Oh, brothers, ...

3. Oh, children, ...

4. Oh, sinners, ...